

# From Mean to Harmful

Recognize, Respond, Report



**BIG IDEA** Cyberbullying is bullying through technology. Four questions help tell mean from harmful: Repeated? Hurtful? Public or hidden? Power? Respond in ways that protect you and the target, and report in the app and at school.

**1 HOOK** 2'

**2 ACTIVITY** 8'

**3 DISCUSS** 3'

**4 TAKEAWAY** 2'

**REVIEW STATUS** Educator review before use. Counsel should confirm the evidence wording in the teacher notes before the lesson goes to families. [COUNSEL TO CONFIRM]

**COUNSELOR HEADS-UP FIRST + OPT-OUT PLAN** Counselor heads-up recommended: students may disclose being targeted, or having taken part. Ask about known incidents. No formal opt-out is expected; the alternate is the Response Menu on two cards, individually.

**1 HOOK 2 MIN 60-second script** Say: “Hackles up? When something online starts as teasing and keeps going, or makes someone go quiet, notice it. You do not need to be sure to pause. Florida law defines cyberbullying as bullying through technology or electronic communication. Today you ask four questions that help tell mean from harmful, then practice what to do and where to report.”

**2 ACTIVITY 8 MIN** *Four Questions and the Response Menu*

- 1 (1 min) The Four-Question Strip. REPEATED** (more than once?). **HURTFUL** (humiliates, threatens, excludes, spreads private information?). **PUBLIC OR HIDDEN** (many eyes, or anonymous?). **POWER** (outnumbered, less popular, picked on for who they are?). Two or more yes: harmful, and never a joke.
- 2 (3 min) Sort in pairs.** Eight cards into ANNOYING, HURTING or TELL NOW. The threat card and the intimate-picture card land at TELL NOW; the single rude comment lands at ANNOYING.
- 3 (3 min) Response Menu** in groups of 4: do not retaliate; SAVE words, usernames, times; block or mute; report in the app; support the target privately; tell a trusted adult; report at school. **Evidence rule:** (1) words and records: screenshots are fine, kept private. (2) Intimate or sexual pictures of anyone under 18, AI fakes included: never screenshot, save, forward or show anyone; tell a trusted adult. (3) Not sure? Do not capture it; tell first. Threats or requests for pictures or money: tell first, delete nothing.
- 4 (1 min) Where to report.** Your school’s bullying process; a trusted adult you choose; law enforcement for threats or crimes; 911 in danger.

**3 DISCUSS 3 MIN**

- 1** “Which question helps most in telling mean from harmful?”
- 2** “Why is ‘do not retaliate’ hard, and a good first rule?”
- 3** “How can a screenshot be used for help and for harm?”

## IF A STUDENT TELLS YOU SOMETHING

- **Say:** “Thank you for telling me. It is not your fault.”
- “We will work it out together.”
- For a student who took part: “Thank you for being honest. You can stop and make it right.”
- **Do not say:** “Just ignore it.”
- “Why didn’t you tell sooner?”
- Asking for images.

**PREP IN 5 MINUTES**

**Materials:** RP4 Situation Cards (eight, fictional; one set per pair), Four-Question Strip, Response Menu, Reporting Quick Card, Workbook W-P4, Question Box.

- ☐ Fictional situations only. Never ask who has been bullied. No real chats or screenshots.
- ☐ Post the evidence rule (step 3); know who takes bullying reports.

**4 TAKEAWAY 2 MIN** “Pause before you reply or add to the pile. Check the four questions. Tell a trusted adult, and report in the app and at school. It is never the target’s fault, and saving evidence is for adults who can help.”

**Hand signal:** Hackles up (hand brushed up the neck, optional). Post it: “Repeated, hurtful, public, powerless? Treat it as harm. Tell first.”

**EXIT TICKET** “Write the first move you would make for a TELL NOW card, and one person you would tell.”

**FUN BOOST Menu Match (calm).** Groups swap a card and add one move the first group missed.

**LEVEL-UP Upstander guide.** One page for younger students (counselor-approved).

**DIFFERENTIATE** Use four cards and a labeled Response Menu.

**FAMILY CARD** Ask your teen the four questions. A nude or sexual picture of a young person is never saved or sent; tell a trusted adult. If your teen is targeted, call the school counselor.

**First 10 Minutes:** see the Disclosure Guide.

**Then:** threats, sexual images of a minor, self-harm, hate or stalking: tell your counselor or designated person and an administrator the same day; follow your school policy and your state’s reporting law.